DRIVEN - STREET LEVEL HEROIC RPG V2

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Errata and the latest rules: https://stephensmith76.github.io/driven/#/errata

Overview

Driven is a tactical street-level heroic RPG about vigilantes who get worn down by the city, and whose flaws break before their bodies do. Fights are quick and played on a simple zone map. Everything around the fights (cases, civilian life, the cops, the press) runs on clocks and Traits.

Core idea: your Trait is your strength and your weak spot. Pressure (Stress) makes it stronger, then makes it dangerous, then breaks you.

What you need: 2d10 per player (a third d10 for Advantage), a GM, character sheets, and a sheet of paper for the zone map. Minis or tokens are optional.

Scale: heroes are street level. Top stat is +4. Guns hurt. Nobody throws buses.

How a session runs: each session is one **Night**. Heroes investigate (Patrol), fight (Confrontation), then deal with the fallout in their civilian lives (Dawn). A case usually takes 2 to 4 Nights. An arc of several cases ends with a chance to change your Trait (Old Habits).

How to Build a Hero (Character Creation Walkthrough)

Creating a vigilante takes just a few minutes. Follow these six steps to build your character:

1. **Choose an Archetype:** Pick how you fight and what drives you. Options include Protector, Brawler, Stalker, Specialist, and Detective. This gives you your Drive trigger, a special Quick Action/feature, and a Signature Move.
2. **Assign Stats:** You have four stats: Force, Flow, Focus, and Presence. Pick one array and assign the numbers to your stats:
   - **Specialist Array:** +4, +2, +1, -1
   - **Balanced Array:** +3, +2, +1, 0

   Calculate your Defenses: Guard = 12 + Flow, Wits = 12 + Focus, Poise = 12 + Presence. If your Force is +3 or higher, you gain Toughness 1 (against blunt/blades).
3. **Pick a Trait:** This is your emotional core and decides how Stress affects you. Choose from: Justice, Vengeance, Mercy, Spite, Order, Vanity, Guilt, Thrill, Loyalty, Obsession, Fear, or Duty. Write four connections that tie you to the world.
4. **Pick a Flair:** Choose one special rule that defines your style. Core flairs are The Best, Hard to Kill, A Thing or Two, Plugs, Opportunist, and Fast Hands (with many more trial options available).
5. **Gear and Powers:** You get 3 slots to equip your hero. Everyone also carries a knife and one free weapon of their choice.
   - Gear = 1 slot
   - Street Power = 1 slot
   - Strange Power = 2 slots

At creation, you can have at most one strange power. (Note: Specialists get a utility belt with 3 extra belt slots, and Gadgeteers get 2.)

6. **Final Details:** Every hero starts with 4 Harm boxes, 8 Stress boxes, and 2 Drive. Finally, name your civilian anchor—a day job, a loved one, or whatever keeps you human—this ties to your Home clock.

The core roll

Every roll is **2d10 + a stat against a defense**. The amount you beat it by sets your **Impact**.

Margin = your total minus the defense.

Margin	Result	In a fight	Outside a fight
Below 0	Miss	The GM makes a move against you	It fails or goes wrong, GM makes a move
0 to 3	Impact 1	1 Harm	You get it, with a cost or complication
4 to 7	Impact 2	2 Harm	Clean success
8+	Impact 3	3 Harm	Success plus a bonus (a clue, a position, an opening)

The defense is always **12 + a stat**, either the target's or an obstacle's rating (see Stats and Defenses). Every roll in the game uses this one table. When an Impact 1 comes with a cost, the GM offers two that fit the scene and you pick one.

Impact tops out at 3. Bonuses from weapons, powers and Signatures add **Harm**, not Impact, so a hit can deal 4 or more Harm, but the roll's Impact stays what the dice made it. An Impact 2 with a crowbar deals 3 Harm and is still an Impact 2: it drops one mook, not two. Anything that triggers on Impact 3 (a second mook dropping, the Impact 3 bonus) needs a real Impact 3 from the roll, or a Drive upgrade.

Edge: +2 to the roll. Only one Edge per roll, whatever the source.

Advantage / Disadvantage: roll 3d10, keep the best two (or the worst two). They cancel each other out and never stack: if a roll has any Advantage and any Disadvantage, it has neither, no matter how many sources of each. Edge and Advantage can apply to the same roll.

Odds at a glance (your stat vs the stat behind the defense):

Your stat vs theirs	Miss	Impact 1	Impact 2	Impact 3
3 lower	79%	18%	3%	0%
Equal	55%	30%	14%	1%
2 higher	36%	36%	22%	6%
3 higher	28%	36%	26%	10%
5 higher	15%	30%	34%	21%

Edge is worth about the same as being 2 points better. Advantage is a little stronger, about 2.5 points.

Stats and defenses

Every stat is used both to act and to defend, so no build is left wide open.

Stat	Act with it to	Defense	Defends against
Force	Hit hard, break things, lift, hold on	**Toughness** (see below)	Reduces the Harm you take
Flow	Move, dodge, sneak, shoot, improvise	**Guard** = 12 + Flow	Punches, bullets, thrown things
Focus	Investigate, hack, use gadgets, read people	**Wits** = 12 + Focus	Ambushes, tricks, illusions, lies
Presence	Intimidate, inspire, persuade, taunt	**Poise** = 12 + Presence	Fear, threats, manipulation

Toughness: Force +3 or higher gives Toughness 1. Toughness reduces each hit's Impact by 1, but a hit always does at least 1 Harm: an Impact 1 hit against Toughness 1 still deals 1 Harm. It doesn't work against guns unless you have armor or a power that says it does. Toughness doesn't stack: use your single highest source for that attack. Only effects that say "+1 Toughness" (Stand Your Ground, Hold the line) add on top. Toughness can never go above 2. Toughness covers physical blows, blades, and (with armor) bullets. Gas, fire, electricity, and other hazards ignore it unless a power or piece of armor says otherwise.

Where your Toughness comes from	Blunt	Blades	Guns	Electricity, gas, fire
Force +3 or higher	1	1	0	0
Kevlar vest	0	1	1	0
Tactical armor, Armored power	1	1	1	0
Powered armor	2	2	2	0
Resilience (street power)	1	0	0	0

Take the single highest row that applies to the attack, never two added together. A hero with Force +4 and a Kevlar vest has Toughness 1 against a punch and Toughness 1 against a bullet, never 2.

Presence attacks deal Stress, not Harm. A villain who rattles you with a threat rolls Presence vs your Poise.

Starting stats

Pick one array and assign it to your four stats:

- **Specialist:** +4, +2, +1, -1
- **Balanced:** +3, +2, +1, 0

Stats range from -1 to +4. Nothing in the game goes higher than +4 for heroes.

Obstacles

Things that aren't people get a rating, and the defense is 12 + rating. Roll whichever stat fits how you approach it.

Rating	Defense	Examples
-1	11	A locked door, a chain-link fence, a nervous witness
+1	13	A police database, a three-story drop, a crowd turning ugly
+3	15	A corporate server, a car going 60, a hardened mob boss

If there's no real opposition and failure wouldn't be interesting, don't roll. Just say it happens.

Harm is damage to your body. Each point of Impact fills one Harm box, top to bottom.

Heroes: 4 boxes

Box	What it means
Bruised	No effect. Clears after any short breather.
Hurt	No effect yet, but you're one box from real trouble.
Wounded	Disadvantage on Force and Flow rolls.
Down	You're out of the fight. You can talk, crawl, or make one desperate Quick Action per round at Disadvantage. Or spend your whole turn on Second Wind (3 Drive, no roll, once per fight).

Past Down: if a Downed hero takes more Harm, they're **Dying**. A single hit stops at Down, however big it is: only a later hit makes you Dying. A Dying hero dies at the end of the scene unless an ally spends a Full Action next to them to stabilize them. Street level means people can actually die, so the GM should make this a clear choice, never a surprise. In practice, death only comes when an enemy hits someone already Down. That's the hardest move the GM has: use it when the villain is a killer or the fiction demands it, and say it out loud first ("He's going to finish you") so the team can act.

Mooks: 1 box

Any hit takes a mook out. An Impact 3 hit also drops a second mook in the same zone. When mooks attack, they deal at most **2 Harm** per attack. Apply the cap last, after the gun bonus, armor, and Toughness.

Named villains: 5 to 10 boxes

Lieutenants have 5. A case's main villain has 10, or 8 for a smaller one. Villains don't take penalties as they fill up, but many have a Trait that kicks in when they're Fraying (see Villains).

Weapons

Everyone carries a knife and one free weapon (see Weapons you carry).

Weapon	Effect
Fists, kicks, thrown junk	No change
Heavy melee (bat, pipe, crowbar)	+1 Harm on a hit, but it takes a Full Action
Blades	+1 Harm against anyone with no Toughness
Guns	+1 Harm on Impact 2 or better (a graze is just a graze) and ignores natural Toughness, though armor still works. Firing one is loud: +1 Heat

Armor (a vest, a reinforced suit) gives Toughness as listed under Gear and Powers. A hero with Force +3 and armor still has Toughness 1, not 2.

Recovery

- **Breather** (a few quiet minutes between scenes): clear Bruised.
- **Dawn** (see The Night): Patch Up clears Hurt and Wounded.
- **Down** after a fight: when the fight ends, a hero who is Down (but not Dying) gets back on their feet at Wounded and can carry on with the Night, at Disadvantage on Force and Flow until they heal. A hero who was Dying and got stabilized stays Down until Dawn, and only clears it with Patch Up and Sleep It Off together. Second Wind and a med kit get you up at Wounded in the middle of a fight.

Stress and Traits

Harm is your body. Stress is your nerves, your temper, your life falling apart. Your **Trait** decides what Stress does to you: it makes you stronger, then dangerous, then it breaks you.

The Stress track: 8 boxes

Stress	Stage	What happens
0 to 3	**Steady**	Your Trait's Steady perk is on.
4 to 7	**Fraying**	Your Trait's Fraying perk replaces the Steady perk. The GM gets your Trait's hook.
8	**Breaking**	Your Trait's Breaking fallout takes over for the rest of the scene. If you Break while Down, the fallout waits until you're back on your feet.

You gain Stress when:

- you Strain for an extra action (1)
- a Presence attack hits you (1 Stress per Impact)
- someone you're protecting gets hurt or dies on your watch (1 to 2)
- the GM makes a hard move on your miss (1)
- you act against your Trait (1)

How Stress builds (it should climb steadily across a Night):

1. **Scheme ticks wear everyone down.** Each time the Scheme clock ticks, someone takes 1 Stress. If a hero's roll made it tick (a Miss or a cost on a lead), only that hero takes it. If it ticks at Dawn or from a missed Crack the Case, every hero takes 1.
2. **Going Down hurts more than your body.** A hero who goes Down takes 2 Stress. Every hero who sees an ally go Down takes 1, but only the first time in each fight.
3. **Villains get in your head.** Every named villain has a Presence attack in their stat block (vs Poise, deals Stress). Once per round they can use it as a free extra action, on top of their normal turn, so threats never cost them an attack.
4. **Stress as a cost.** On Impact 1, the GM offers 1 Stress as one of the two costs when it fits the fiction.

With these in play, Sleep It Off at Dawn becomes a real choice.

After Breaking: at the end of the scene, drop to 4 Stress, gain 2 Drive, and tick your Home clock once (it follows you home).

Clearing Stress: mostly at Dawn (see The Night). Stress carries over from Night to Night if you don't deal with it.

The GM's hook: while you're Fraying, the GM can use your hook to push a complication on you. If you go along with it, gain 1 Drive. If you refuse, take 1 Stress.

Traits

Pick one. Each Trait lists how it earns Drive, its two perks, its hook, and how you break.

Justice

- *Drive:* when you do the right thing instead of the easy thing.
- *Steady:* Edge on rolls to stop someone hurting an innocent.

- *Fraying:* that Edge becomes Advantage. *Hook:* you won't let a guilty person walk, even when chasing them costs the team.
- *Breaking:* you go after the guilty party alone, ignoring orders and danger.

Vengeance

- *Drive:* when you go after someone who hurt you or yours.
- *Steady:* Edge against anyone who has hurt you this Night.
- *Fraying:* +1 Harm on hits against them. *Hook:* you can't let them get away.
- *Breaking:* you go too far. The GM asks how far, and you answer honestly. Take +1 Heat.

Mercy

- *Drive:* when you risk yourself to save someone, even an enemy.
- *Steady:* when you Help an ally, they get Advantage instead of Edge.
- *Fraying:* clear 1 Stress whenever you pull someone out of danger. *Hook:* you can't leave anyone in danger, enemies included.
- *Breaking:* you automatically take every hit aimed at anyone in your zone until the scene ends.

Spite

- *Drive:* when you get even.
- *Steady:* when someone hurts you, your next attack on them has Edge.
- *Fraying:* whenever you take Harm, your attacker takes 1 Stress. *Hook:* you can't back down from an insult or a challenge.
- *Breaking:* you attack whoever is closest, friend or foe.

Order

- *Drive:* when the team follows a plan you made.
- *Steady:* when you lay out a plan, name one step of it. The roll for that step has Edge, whoever makes it. Once per scene.
- *Fraying:* that Edge becomes Advantage. *Hook:* when the plan falls apart, you have Disadvantage until you spend a Full Action making a new one.
- *Breaking:* you freeze or double down on a plan that's clearly failing. The GM picks which.

Vanity

- *Drive:* when you show off in front of witnesses.
- *Steady:* Edge on Presence rolls when people are watching.
- *Fraying:* +1 Impact on flashy moves. *Hook:* take +1 Heat any time you act in public.
- *Breaking:* you grandstand. Each turn you do the most impressive thing available, even if it leaves your team exposed.

Guilt

- *Drive:* when you take the blame or the pain for something that isn't your fault.
- *Steady:* clear Bruised when you protect someone.
- *Fraying:* Advantage when protecting someone like the person you failed. *Hook:* you can't turn down someone who asks for help.
- *Breaking:* you shut down and lose your next turn. Then you confess something true to someone who shouldn't hear it.

Thrill

- *Drive:* when you pick the riskier option.
- *Steady:* once per fight, Strain costs no Stress.
- *Fraying:* Advantage on Flow rolls. *Hook:* you won't take cover or retreat.
- *Breaking:* you do the most dangerous thing in reach and drag someone into it with you.

Loyalty

- *Drive:* when you take a risk for a connection or a teammate.
- *Steady:* Edge on rolls made to protect, help or avenge one of your connections or a teammate.
- *Fraying:* that Edge becomes Advantage. *Hook:* you won't leave anyone behind or sell anyone out.
- *Breaking:* you shield them from the truth or the law, even when they're wrong: you lie, hide evidence, or step between them and justice. Take +1 Heat.

Obsession

- *Drive:* when you chase your target past what's sensible.
- *Steady:* At the start of each Night, name one person or case as your target. Edge on rolls that move it forward.
- *Fraying:* +1 Harm on hits against your target. *Hook:* you ignore anything that isn't about the target.
- *Breaking:* you abandon the team or a civilian to chase the lead. The GM picks which.

Fear

- *Drive:* when you act despite being scared.
- *Steady:* Edge on the first roll you make in each fight.
- *Fraying:* Clear 1 Stress whenever an attack against you Misses. *Hook:* you overprepare and won't go in blind.
- *Breaking:* you run, or you strike first and hardest at the thing you're afraid of. The GM picks which.

Duty

- *Drive:* when you keep your word or follow your code at a cost.
- *Steady:* Edge on rolls to keep an oath, a promise or your code.
- *Fraying:* that Edge becomes Advantage. *Hook:* you won't break your code, even when it's tactically dumb.
- *Breaking:* you follow the code into disaster, whoever it costs.

Drive

Drive is your heroic fuel. There is one price list for everyone. Archetypes change how you earn Drive, never what it costs.

You hold up to 6 Drive. Start each Night with 2. At Dawn, anything above 3 drops to 3.

Earning Drive

Source	Gain	Limit
Your archetype trigger	1	Once per round
Your Trait's Drive trigger	1	Once per scene
Going along with the GM's hook while Fraying	1	Each time

Source	Gain	Limit
Breaking (at the end of the scene)	2	Each time

In a fight, expect to earn about 1 Drive every two rounds.

Spending Drive

Cost	Effect	When
1	**Edge** (+2)	Before you roll
2	**Upgrade:** raise a hit by one Impact level (1 to 2, or 2 to 3; Impact 3 is the top)	After any roll that hits (attacks, leads, Crack the Case), once per roll
3	**Signature Move**	On your turn, as its own action (see Archetypes)

You can spend Drive on an ally's roll for Edge if you're in the same zone and can say how you're helping. Second Wind costs 3 Drive, once per fight, with no roll: clear one Harm box as a Full Action. For a Downed hero it takes the whole turn and puts them back up at Wounded.

Fights

Fights happen on a map of 3 to 6 **zones**: named areas like *Loading Dock*, *Catwalk*, *Back Office*. Draw them as boxes on paper and connect the ones you can move between. No grid, no counting squares.

Zones and range

Give each zone 0 to 2 tags: **Cover**, **High Ground**, **Dark**, **Cramped**, **Hazard** (fire, traffic, a live wire), **Crowd**.

Range	Means	Who can hit you
Engaged	Toe to toe with someone in your zone	Melee and point-blank shots
Near	Same zone, not engaged	Guns, thrown things, Presence
Far	An adjacent zone	Guns at Disadvantage (rifles and Specialists ignore this)
Out of reach	Two or more zones away	Nobody, unless a power says so

What the tags do:

- **Cover:** Take Cover (Quick Action) gives +2 Guard until your next turn. You can Vanish here.
- **Dark:** ranged attacks in or into the zone are at Disadvantage. You can Vanish here.
- **Crowd:** you can Vanish here. Guns fired into a Crowd risk hitting bystanders (a fair GM move on any miss).
- **Hazard:** any missed roll in this zone costs 1 Harm, heroes and villains alike.
- **High Ground:** ranged attacks from it get Edge. Melee can't reach you unless the attacker climbs up first, which is a move or, on a hard climb, a roll.
- **Cramped:** heavy melee and long guns are at Disadvantage, and no more than two people can be engaged with any one person. A good spot for one hero to hold off a gang.

Turn order

Heroes go first unless they were ambushed. Then sides alternate: one hero, then one villain or mook group, then another hero, and so on. The players pick which hero goes next. If one side runs out of turns, the other side finishes theirs.

At the **end of each round**, tick any clocks in play (a hostage, a fuse, sirens getting closer).

Your turn

You get **one free move** (to an adjacent zone, or into or out of engagement in your zone), plus **one Full Action or two Quick Actions**.

Full Actions

- **Strike:** attack with Force, Flow, or Presence. Normal Impact.
- **Signature Move:** costs 3 Drive (see Archetypes).
- **Stabilize:** save a Dying ally next to you.
- **Swing something heavy:** a heavy melee weapon attack (+1 Harm).

Quick Actions

- **Jab:** a quick attack at -2. A hit is always Impact 1, so bonuses that need Impact 2 or better (light weapons, guns) never apply to a Jab. Once per turn.
- **Move:** go one more zone.
- **Help:** give an ally in your zone Edge on their next roll.
- **Take Cover:** in a Cover zone, +2 Guard until your next turn.
- **Interact:** grab, open, throw a switch, kick a gun away.
- **Archetype Quick Actions:** listed under each archetype.

Breaking away: if you leave engagement, the enemy you were engaged with can make a free Jab at you.

Strain

Once per turn, take 1 Stress to get an extra Quick Action.

Enemies

Villains and mooks roll 2d10 + their stat against your defense, the same way you do. Mooks act in groups of up to 3. Each group makes one attack per turn, with Edge if all 3 are still standing.

Hard-to-hit enemies: a defense of 15 or more (a dodgy gunman at Flow +3) means a +3 hero misses about half the time. That's the point: those enemies are out-thought, not out-punched. Use one per fight at most, and make sure the fight offers a way to get Edge or Advantage: Read, Help, Hidden, a Flashbang, High Ground.

Give the fight a goal

Most fights need a goal other than beating everyone: a hostage clock, a getaway van, evidence burning, cops on the way. If both sides can just slug it out, the fight runs long and the zones stop mattering. Goals are also where non-fighters earn their spot: grabbing the evidence, holding a door, talking a hostage-taker down, or disarming a device should end a fight as decisively as a knockout.

The Night

A session is one Night: **Patrol**, then **Confrontation**, then **Dawn**. Dawn is where the costs of the mask catch up with you.

[embedded content: one Night · 3 phases, repeated until the case closes]

Not every Night ends in the big fight. Early Nights usually end with a smaller fight against mooks or a lieutenant.

Patrol: working the case

Investigation never stalls. If your approach fits a lead, you get the clue. The roll only decides what it costs you.

Case prep (GM, about 15 minutes):

- **Three facets:** Who's behind it? What do they want? Where will they strike?
- **The cast:** 4 to 6 suspects, factions, or players, each with a motive and something to hide.
- **8 to 12 clues:** concrete facts (a burned ledger page, a van with fake plates, a dockworker who quit the same week). Each one should fit more than one suspect.
- **3 to 5 leads:** places and people the heroes can go lean on.
- **Complexity:** 4 for a one-Night job, 6 for a normal case, 8 for an arc finale.
- **A Scheme clock:** 6 segments (see below).

Two ways to run a case. The GM picks for each case:

- **Fixed Culprit (default).** The GM decides who's behind it before play. Everything else (what they want, where they'll strike, how it connects) comes from the players' theory. Use this for recurring villains, secret identities, or any idea the GM wants to land.
- **Floating.** Nobody knows who did it, the GM included. The theory decides everything. Good for early sessions or when the GM wants to improvise. Clues have to stay open enough to point several ways.

A campaign can start Floating and move to Fixed Culprit once recurring villains show up. Switching between cases is fine.

Following a lead: describe your approach and roll the stat that fits against the lead's rating. You get the clue no matter what.

Result	You get
Miss	The clue, and the GM picks a cost: tick the Scheme clock, +1 Heat, 1 Stress, or an ambush
Impact 1	The clue, and you pick one of those costs
Impact 2	The clue, clean
Impact 3	The clue, plus one: a second clue, Edge against the villain in the showdown, or a hint at their Weakness

Plan on 1 or 2 lead scenes per hero per Night.

The Scheme clock is the villain's plan moving forward. It ticks at every Dawn and whenever a cost says so. If it fills before you crack the case, the villain pulls it off. You still get a showdown, but on their ground, after the damage is done.

Personal clues. Put 1 or 2 clues in each case that hit close to home. Early on, pull them from backstories: the victim is Rook's old sparring partner. Once the campaign is moving, pull them from **earlier issues**: a villain who got away, a witness you saved, a promise you broke, a Breaking scene that came back around. A personal clue counts as **2 clues** in a theory, but using it ticks that hero's Home clock. The case followed you home.

Arc clues. Some clues point past this case to whoever is pulling strings across the arc. They don't count toward the current case. Keep them on their own list for the arc's finale.

Drive while investigating (1 Drive each): call in a contact for a new lead, ask the GM one yes-or-no question about a clue, or flash back to something you set up earlier (a tracker, a bribe, a bug in the office).

Cracking the case

When the team holds clues equal to at least half the Complexity and agrees on a theory that answers all three facets, roll **2d10 + clues used against 10 + Complexity**. Clues that don't fit the theory don't count. Call them red herrings.

Result	Meaning
Miss	Wrong. The GM says which part doesn't hold up, and the Scheme clock ticks twice. Try again once you have at least one new clue.
Impact 1	Right, with a snag: they're ready for you, or it's the right place but the wrong night
Impact 2	Right
Impact 3	Right, and you also learn the villain's Weakness or gain an arc clue

With clues equal to the Complexity, the theory is right 64% of the time. Two extra clues raises that to 79%. Going in with half drops it to 36%.

Fixed Culprit and the wrong name: if the theory hits but names the wrong person, the plan and the place are still right. The person you named was working for the real culprit, who gets away clean and becomes a lead for a later case.

Confrontation: whose ground?

- **Impact 2 or 3:** you choose the ground. Take the first move, or add one zone tag of your choice to the map.
- **Impact 1:** you know where, but they're ready. No ambush either way, and the villain starts with +1 Drive.
- **A miss you couldn't fix, or a full Scheme clock:** the villain chooses the ground and gets the ambush.

Dawn: the cost of the mask

Each hero picks **two**:

- **Sleep It Off:** clear all Stress.
- **Patch Up:** clear Hurt and Wounded. Pick both this and Sleep It Off to clear Down.
- **Show Up:** be there for your civilian life. If you don't pick this, tick your Home clock.
- **Lay Low:** clear 1 Heat.
- **Work the Case:** chase one lead off-screen and take 1 clue, no roll.

You can never do everything. That's the point.

The clocks

Clock	Size	Ticks when	At half	When it fills
Scheme (team)	6	Every Dawn, and as a cost when following leads	The villain knows someone is digging	The villain pulls it off. The showdown happens on their ground, after the damage is done.

Clock	Size	Ticks when	At half	When it fills
Heat (team)	6	Guns (and being seen with a long gun), public fights, collateral damage, Vanity, Vengeance, sloppy feeding (Vampirism on Impact 1 or a miss), a Marked hero seen by civilians	Cops show up to fights on round 3	Crackdown: a task force, a smear in the press, or someone gets a description. Play it out, then drop Heat to 2.
Home (each hero)	6	You skip Show Up, you Break, you use a personal clue, you use Resources to buy past a problem, or a villain finds your Lair (+2)	Someone close starts asking questions	Home crisis: lose the job, the relationship ends, someone learns who you are, or a loved one becomes a target. Play it out, then reset to 0.

Heroes with no civilian life. A pure vigilante has no day job or alter ego. Their civilian life, and so Show Up and the Home clock, just stands for whatever anchors them to their humanity, even if it's only feeding a goldfish. Name it when you build the hero. When Home ticks, that anchor is what's slipping, and a Home crisis is that anchor being lost, found or threatened.

Archetypes

Your archetype is how you fight and how you earn Drive. Each one has a **Drive trigger** (once per round), a **feature**, and a **Signature Move** (3 Drive, Full Action).

Protector

You stand between people and harm.

- **Drive trigger:** an enemy attacks you (hit or miss), or you take a hit meant for someone else.
- **Interpose** (Quick): until your next turn, when an enemy attacks someone in your zone, you can make yourself the target instead. Once per round.
- **Signature: Stand Your Ground.** Until your next turn, every attack in your zone has to target you, you get +1 Toughness (max 2), and allies in your zone get Edge on their next roll.

Brawler

You wade in and keep swinging.

- **Drive trigger:** you take Harm, or you drop an enemy.
- **Pile Through:** when your Strike drops a mook, make a free Jab against another enemy in your zone.
- **Signature: Haymaker.** A Strike with Advantage and +1 Harm. On a hit, knock the target into an adjacent zone of your choice.

Stalker

You strike from the dark and are gone before they turn around.

- **Drive trigger:** you attack while Hidden, or you break away from engagement without getting hit.
- **Vanish** (Quick): in a Dark, Cover, or Crowd zone, roll Flow against the highest Wits of anyone watching. On a hit you're **Hidden**: you can't be targeted, and your first attack from Hidden has Advantage (attacking ends Hidden).
- **Signature: Take Down.** A Strike from Hidden. If it hits, it counts as Impact 3.

Specialist

Gadgets, trick shots, and a plan for everything.

- **Drive trigger:** you use a tool to change the fight (a new zone tag, a moved enemy, a blocked exit).
- **Utility belt:** 3 belt slots, on top of your 3 slots. At the start of each Night, fill them with tools or light armor (any one-slot gear that isn't a weapon). Belt gear works exactly like gear. Expecting guns? Take smoke grenades or a Kevlar vest: without them, a Specialist is usually the first one down.
- **Signature: Prepared.** Reveal something you set up earlier: a new exit, a trap (Impact 2 to whoever sets it off, ignoring Toughness), or backup arriving. Then take Advantage on your next roll.

Detective

You read people and see the fight coming.

- **Drive trigger:** you learn something true about an enemy, you find a clue, or an ally hits using the Edge from your Read.
- **Case Sense:** once per case, one clue you found counts as two in the team's theory.
- **Read** (Quick, in a fight): roll Focus against a target's Wits. For each Impact level, ask one: *What's their weakness? What will they do next? What are they protecting?* The GM answers truthfully, and your team's next roll against that target has Edge. If you asked about their weakness, a hit with that Edge also ignores Toughness: you showed them where to strike.
- **Signature: Called It.** Name what a villain will do next. When they try it, it fails, and every ally gets a free Quick Action.

Sample heroes

Hero	Archetype	Trait	Force	Flow	Focus	Presence	Guard / Wits / Poise	Toughness
Bulwark (Dana Okafor, ex-firefighter)	Protector	Mercy	+3	0	+1	+2	12 / 13 / 14	1
Rook (Tommy Reyes, washed-up boxer)	Brawler	Spite	+4	+2	-1	+1	14 / 11 / 13	1
Nightjar (Lena Cho, bike courier)	Stalker	Vengeance	+1	+4	+2	-1	16 / 14 / 11	0
Patchwork (Desmond Hale, engineering dropout)	Specialist	Thrill	0	+2	+3	+1	14 / 15 / 13	0
The Ledger (Ruth Abernathy, retired fraud investigator)	Detective	Order	-1	+1	+4	+2	13 / 16 / 14	0

All heroes start with 4 Harm boxes, 8 Stress boxes, and 2 Drive.

Flairs

Pick one at character creation.

- **The Best:** when you go Down, take one Full Action first.
- **Hard to Kill:** add a fifth Harm box, *Battered*, between Hurt and Wounded.
- **A Thing or Two:** Edge on Patrol rolls in your own neighborhood.
- **Plugs:** once per Night, a contact gives you 1 clue, no roll. Each use ticks your Home clock or Heat (your choice).
- **Opportunist:** once per scene, when an enemy misses you, gain 1 Drive.
- **Fast Hands:** once per turn, Interact is free.

Resources (trial Flair): money, a company, or a rich patron. At each Dawn you can swap any of your gear for other gear from the list. Once per Night, buying your way past a problem (a bribe, a rented space, a lawyer) counts as Impact 2 with no roll, but ticks Home by 1: someone in your daytime life notices.

Acrobat (trial Flair): Hazard zones don't cost you Harm on a miss, and you can move into a zone and climb to its High Ground in the same free move.

Already Broken (trial Flair): your Stress never drops below 4, so you're always Fraying and the GM always has a hook. In return, start each Night with 4 Drive instead of 2.

The Roast (trial Flair): once per fight, as a Quick Action, roll Presence against a named enemy's Poise. On a hit, they take Stress equal to the Impact and the next attack against them has Edge. A Miss costs you 1 Stress: it landed badly.

Patient Hunter (trial Flair): once per Night, when you take a clue, take it clean: no cost is paid, even on a Miss.

Sucker Punch (trial Flair): your first attack against an enemy who hasn't acted yet has Edge.

Bodyguard (trial Flair): once per round, take a hit aimed at an ally in your zone. You take 1 less Harm from it.

Quick Study (trial Flair): once per scene, after a villain spends Drive on a Trick against you, you have Edge against that villain for the rest of the scene.

Chill (trial Flair): once per fight, ignore one Stress you would gain, or clear 1 Stress when you roll Impact 3.

Rooftop Runner (trial Flair): your free move can cross one extra zone, and you can leave a fight without a roll.

Smarmy (trial Flair): once per Night, a Presence roll to talk someone down or past a door counts as one Impact higher (still capped at 3).

Scrapper (trial Flair): once per scene, when you're outnumbered in your zone, your next attack has Edge and deals +1 Harm.

Trick Arrows (trial Flair): you need a bow as one of your weapons. Twice per fight, add one effect to a bow attack, a different arrow each time. Net: the target can't take their free move until they spend a Quick Action to get free. Flash: the target has Disadvantage on their next roll. Grapple: you move to any zone you can see, including High Ground. Boom: on a hit, everyone else in the target's zone takes 1 Harm.

Connections

Every hero is tied to the world by four connections, written at character creation, one line each. They are what the GM can lean on and what the player has to lose.

- **Someone you protect.** This is your stake. A person you would take a hit for, or can't afford to lose.
- **Someone with leverage over you.** A debt, a secret, a boss, a cop, a promise. This is the GM's lever.
- **A place you're tied to.** A block, a bar, a rooftop, a grave.
- **A mistake that could come back.** An old case gone wrong, someone you failed.

At least one connection should link you to another hero. At the table, ask: how do we know each other?

The GM uses connections for Impact 1 costs, Miss moves, Home crises (a loved one becomes a target, someone learns who you are) and personal clues, which already count double and tick your Home clock. When a connection is lost, resolved or betrayed, write a new one at the next Dawn.

A hero with no civilian life still has connections. Their "someone you protect" can be anything that anchors them to their humanity, even a goldfish.

Advancement

When a case closes, each hero picks one: +1 to a stat (max +4), a new Flair, the next ability on one of their powers, a new slot (spend it on gear or a street power; a strange power needs two slots, so it takes two picks), or an Asset.

Gear and Powers

Street-level heroes don't fight in street clothes. At character creation, every hero gets **3 slots** to spend:

Pick	Cost
A piece of gear	1 slot
A street power	1 slot
A strange power	2 slots

Every hero also carries a free weapon and a knife (see below), which cost no slots. Spend your slots however fits the hero. Three pieces of gear is a Batman or a Punisher. A strange power plus one piece of gear is a Luke Cage or a Jessica Jones. Two street powers and a free weapon is a Daredevil. At creation, a hero can have at most one strange power. Specialists and Gadgeteers also get a utility belt, which sits on top of their slots (see Specialist and Gadgeteer).

Weapons you carry

Everyone carries a **knife**, and every hero also gets **one free weapon** of their choice. Neither costs a slot. Each extra weapon costs 1 slot. A weapon can still be lost: disarming you is a fair GM move.

Weapon	Effect
Knife (everyone has one)	+1 Harm against anyone without Toughness. Can be thrown at Near range. It is a backup: each attack uses one weapon, never two weapon bonuses.
Sidearm (free pick)	A gun (Flow to shoot). Far range is at Disadvantage.
Long gun (free pick)	A gun with no Far penalty. Being seen carrying one is +1 Heat.
Bow (free pick)	Flow to shoot, no Far penalty, +1 Harm on Impact 2 or better. Silent: unlike a gun, it adds no Heat on its own. Not a gun, so Toughness applies.
Light melee (free pick: baton, fighting sticks, weighted gloves)	+1 Harm on Impact 2 or better. Works with Strikes and Jabs.
Heavy melee (free pick: bat, pipe, crowbar)	+1 Harm on any hit, but only as a Full Action.

A stranger weapon, like a mono-edge blade, shock gauntlets or a rail rifle, is the **Special Weapon** street power. Fighting with bare hands is the **Martial Artist** street power.

Gear

Gear is armor and tools. Gear can be lost: smashing your gear, or catching you without it, is a fair GM move. A utility belt (Specialists and Gadgeteers) holds one-slot armor and tools, but never weapons or powered armor.

Armor

Armor	Effect
Kevlar vest	Toughness 1 against guns and blades. Doesn't stack with other Toughness.
Tactical armor	Toughness 1 against everything, but Disadvantage on Vanish and climbing.
Powered armor (takes 2 slots)	Toughness 2 against blunt, blades and guns. Unreliable: when you roll a Miss while wearing it, the GM can cut it out (out of power, a jammed joint, a short circuit, whatever fits the scene). While it is offline it gives no Toughness. Spend a Quick Action to get it running again, or it is repaired at Dawn. Doesn't stack with other Toughness.

Tools

Tool	Effect
Grapple line	Quick Action: move to any zone you can see, including High Ground.
Med kit	Once per fight, Full Action: an ally next to you clears one Harm box (Down becomes Wounded).
Night-vision goggles	Dark zones don't affect you.
Police scanner	Once per Night, Edge on a Patrol roll. You also hear the cops coming a round early.
Earpiece comms	You can Help allies in any zone.

More tools (trial additions, not yet playtested):

Tool	Effect
Taser	A Jab. On a hit, the target loses their next Quick Action. Electricity, so it ignores Toughness. Two uses per fight.
Tracker	Tag someone. If they get away, take 1 clue about where they went.
Pepper spray	Quick Action, Engaged. On a hit, the target has Disadvantage on attacks until the end of their next turn.
Smoke grenades	Quick Action: a zone becomes Dark until the end of next round. Two per fight.
Flashbangs	Quick Action: roll Flow against the Guard of everyone in a zone; everyone you beat has Disadvantage on their next roll. One per fight.
Bolas or net launcher	Ranged, Near. On a hit, the target can't take their free move until they spend a Quick Action to get free.
Riot shield	+1 Guard. Take Cover works anywhere. Disadvantage on Vanish, and you can't use a long gun.
Mask and voice changer	Edge on rolls to scare or bluff someone who doesn't know you. Being unmasked costs 2 Stress instead of 1 Heat.
Lockpicks and bypass kit	Edge on getting through locked doors, alarms and safes. On Patrol, a lead through a locked place costs nothing extra.
Burner phones	Once per Night, contact an informant or ally without ticking Heat.
Bike or car	Out of fights: move between leads with no time cost once per Night. In a chase, Edge on Flow.
Drone	Quick Action: see into any zone within Far range. Allies attacking a target you've spotted get Edge, once per round. Breaks on any hit.
Climbing gear and gloves	Hard climbs to High Ground need no roll. No Hazard cost for falls of one story.
Tossies	Ranged, Near. Flow to throw. A hit deals 1 Harm (Toughness applies). On Impact 2 or better the target drops what they're holding, so their weapon bonus is off until they spend a Quick Action to recover it. If they hold nothing, they lose their next Quick Action instead. Three per fight.
Forensic kit	Once per case, spend a scene working a crime scene or an object and take 1 clue, no roll.

Tool	Effect
Hacking rig	Edge on Focus rolls against systems, cameras and records. Once per Night, take 1 clue from them with no roll. If it comes from police or city records, take +1 Heat.
Weighted lash	A light melee weapon on a cable. +1 Harm on Impact 2 or better, and it works with Strikes and Jabs. Quick Action, Near range: pull an enemy to Engaged with you, or swing yourself to High Ground in your zone or the next one.
Trip mines	Quick Action: set a trap in your zone. The next enemy to move into it takes Impact 2, ignoring Toughness, and stops there. Two per fight.
Scoped rifle	A long gun with a scope. Edge on attacks at Far range if you haven't moved this turn. Being seen carrying one is +1 Heat.
Rebreather	Gas and fumes don't affect you, and you ignore stun grenades and flashbangs (built-in ear and eye protection).
Caltrops	Quick Action: scatter them in a zone you're leaving. Until the end of next round, any enemy who moves in stops there. In a chase, anyone behind you has Disadvantage on Flow rolls. Two per fight.
Tranquilizer darts	Ranged, Near. On a hit, a mook goes down. A named enemy has Disadvantage on all rolls until the end of their next turn, and a second hit in the same fight puts them out. Two per fight.
Restraints	Full Action: bind an enemy who is Down, surrendering or willing. They can't act until freed or the scene ends. A bound prisoner is a Tool you can interrogate.
Disguise kit	Take on a new identity for a scene. Once per Night, pass as someone else with no roll. If you're seen through, take +1 Heat.
Glider cape	Falls of any height cost you nothing, and you can drop into any zone below you as a free move.

Stun grenade (heavier flashbang): Quick Action, Near zone. Everyone there without ear and eye protection rolls Focus vs 12 or loses their next turn; mooks just lose it. Allies in the zone are caught too. One per fight.

Taser gun (dart taser): Near range. On a hit, instead of Harm, the target loses their next Quick Action and a mook drops. Electricity, so it ignores Toughness. Two shots per fight, and reloading between them takes a Quick Action.

Gun rules (all guns): +1 Harm on Impact 2 or better, ignores natural Toughness (Force +3) but not armor, Disadvantage when you're engaged in melee, and +1 Heat for each fight where you fire one.

Assets

Assets are bigger than gear: things you can't carry into a fight, that work between scenes or across a Night. They come only from Advancement (one Asset per pick), never from Resources.

- **Vehicle** (an armored car, a custom bike): travel between leads costs no time, Edge in chases, and once per Night it can crash into a fight as an entrance (move your whole group into any zone, and one mook group drops). Wrecking it costs a Dawn to fix.
- **Lair** (a cave, a rooftop safehouse, a back room): at Dawn there, Sleep It Off clears 1 more Stress and Patch Up clears 1 more Harm. If a villain finds it, Home ticks by 2.
- **Network** (informants, a cop who trusts you, a reporter): once per Night, take a free lead with no cost. Ignore them too long and they start asking for favors.

Powers

Powers are adapted from the Supersworn: Street Level cards. Each power has three abilities. You start with the first. Unlocking the other two is an Advancement option.

- **Street powers** are within peak-human reach: training, technology, or a small gift. Write in a **source**.

- **Strange powers** are clearly superhuman. They cost 2 slots, and you must write in a **cost**: a weakness, a side effect, a price. The GM can use it as a hook.
- **Slots:** a street power costs 1 slot and a strange power costs 2 (see the slot table above). Advancement adds slots.

Push (any power): when your power helps a roll, take 1 Stress to roll with Advantage. Some abilities also cost Stress directly.

Strange powers cost Stress: the first time you use a strange power in a fight or scene, take 1 Stress. Bending reality wears on you. Pushing it costs the usual 1 Stress on top. Street powers have no use cost.

Allergy, Unstable or Marked: whenever you take a strange power, at creation or later, pick one flaw for it.

- **Allergy:** name a weakness (iron, salt, bright light, a sound). When it's present, the power is at Disadvantage. An always-on power that never rolls (Armored, Invulnerability, Healing Factor) simply doesn't work against it: an Invulnerable hero allergic to electricity takes Harm from a live wire, and Healing Factor won't heal damage it caused. Villains who learn it can use it against you.
- **Unstable:** on a Miss with the power, the GM makes a move and the power also misfires in a way that fits it: a teleport lands in the wrong zone, a fire blast catches an ally, telepathy drags you into someone's nightmare. The GM picks the misfire, and most should hit the scene rather than the team. When one does catch an ally, it's an Impact 1 hit on them (armor and Toughness apply as usual).
- **Marked:** the power shows on your body and you look like a monster. Being seen by civilians ticks Heat by 1, and Presence rolls with strangers are at Disadvantage until they get to know you.

Always-on powers: Armored and Invulnerability are strange powers that are always on. Since they're always working, take the 1 Stress the first time the power stops a hit in a fight. They must take Allergy (Unstable has no roll to trigger): while the weakness is present, their Toughness doesn't apply.

Street powers

Gadgeteer (Technology)

- *Start:* Utility belt. You get 2 belt slots: each Night, fill them with tools or light armor (any one-slot gear that isn't a weapon). A Specialist, who already has a belt, gets 5 belt slots instead of 3.
- *Built for this:* once per Night, reveal a gadget made for exactly this. The roll it helps is an automatic Impact 2.
- *Tinker:* when you Patch Up at Dawn, also repair one broken piece of gear.

Resilient (tough and quick to recover; formerly Healing Factor)

- *Start:* Fast mender. A breather clears Bruised and Hurt.
- *Shake it off:* once per fight, Quick Action: clear one Harm box.
- *Not today:* the first time you would die, you survive, out of action until the next Night. Then cross this off.

Peak Strength (peak human; formerly Super-Strength)

- *Start:* Strong like an ox. Edge on Force rolls to lift, break, hold, or throw, and your bare hands count as light melee.
- *Hurl:* on a Strike hit, throw the target into an adjacent zone. If they land on another enemy, both take 1 Harm.
- *Hold the line:* when you Interpose or shield someone, you get +1 Toughness against that hit.

Resilience (street power; hard to hurt)

- *Start:* Tough. Add one Harm box (Battered, between Hurt and Wounded), and you have Toughness 1 against fists and blunt weapons (not blades or bullets: it is grit, not magic). This doesn't stack with Toughness from Force +3 or from any other source: use your single highest.
- *I can take it:* when you take Harm and stay on your feet, gain 1 Drive (once per round).
- *Won't stay down:* once per Night, when you would go Down, stay at Wounded instead.

Enhanced Senses (loud noise, bright light, or strong smells can overwhelm you)

- *Start:* Keen. Edge on Patrol rolls your sense helps, and Dark zones don't give you Disadvantage.
- *Nothing gets past you:* you can't be ambushed, and Dark doesn't hide anyone from you.
- *On the trail:* when someone gets away, roll Focus against 13. On a hit, you know where they went. On Impact 2+, also take a clue.

Danger Sense

- *Start:* Uh oh. +1 Guard.
- *See it coming:* when an attack hits you, take 1 Stress to make the attacker reroll.
- *See the future:* when you miss, the GM offers two moves and you pick which happens.

Special Weapon (write in the weapon)

- *Start:* That ain't a knife. Your weapon works like the closest ordinary weapon (light, heavy or gun) and replaces your free weapon. Your first attack each fight with it has Edge.
- *How's it feel?:* on a hit with it, choose one: the target takes 1 Stress, or +1 Harm on Impact 2 or better.
- *This is a knife:* once per fight, take 1 Stress to reroll a missed attack with it.

Martial Artist (training)

- *Start:* Trained hands. Your bare hands count as light melee (+1 Harm on Impact 2 or better, works with Strikes and Jabs). You can't be disarmed.
- *Turn it back:* once per round, when an enemy you're engaged with misses you, make a free Jab against them.
- *Pressure point:* on a Strike hit at Impact 2 or better, choose one: the target loses their free move, or has Disadvantage on their next attack.

Quick (fast for a human; formerly Super-Speed)

- *Start:* Fast. Your free move covers two zones.
- *Watch me:* Edge on Flow rolls in a fight.
- *Burst:* once per turn, take 1 Stress for an extra Quick Action with Advantage.

Tendrils (Technology)

- *Start:* Movement. Climbing and swinging never need a roll, and your free move can reach High Ground.
- *Combat:* when your Jab hits, you can grab the target instead of hurting them: they can't move on their next turn.
- *Multi-tasking:* once per turn, take 1 Stress to do two Quick Actions with one roll.

Electrical Aptitude (Technology). You hold **Charge**, 0 to 3.

- *Start:* Spark. You start every fight with 1 Charge, and touching live power is a Quick Action to regain it (max 1). Spend 1 Charge for Edge on a roll electricity helps.

- *Surge:* grab high voltage: roll Force against 13. On a hit, gain 3 Charge (max 3). On a miss, take 2 Harm.
- *Strike:* spend up to 2 Charge on an attack: +1 Harm per Charge spent, on a hit.

Custom Power (write in name, source, cost)

- *Start:* Edge on rolls outside a fight that your power helps.
- *Second ability:* Edge on rolls in a fight that your power helps.
- *Third ability:* write your own with the GM, matching the others in strength.

Strange powers

Telepathy (-1 to each roll for each extra person you target)

- *Start:* Quick Action: roll Focus against a target's Wits. On a hit, you read their surface thoughts, and your next roll against them has Edge (Advantage on Impact 2+).
- *Influence:* take 1 Stress, roll Focus against Poise. On a hit, they do one reasonable thing you suggest.
- *Control:* take 2 Stress, roll Focus against Poise. On a hit, you control one person for a scene. On Impact 1 it's only a few minutes, and they remember. Burnout: on a Miss, take 2 more Stress, Telepathy shuts off for the rest of the scene, and the target knows exactly what you tried.

Teleportation

- *Start:* Quick Action: move to any zone you can see. No roll, unless you're escaping someone engaged with you or the zone is Dark, Crowd or smoke-filled: then roll Focus vs 12. On a Miss you land somewhere bad (GM's choice).
- *Combat:* after you teleport, your next attack that turn has Edge.
- *Long distance:* take 3 Stress to go anywhere in the city you've been before.

Elementalist (wind, water, earth, or fire)

- *Start:* Manipulate. When your element is in the zone, Edge on rolls that use it.
- *Surge:* Full Action. Either attack with your element at Near range, with Edge, or reshape a Near zone until the end of the fight: earth adds Cover, water adds Hazard, wind adds Dark or clears smoke and Dark.
- *Draw:* take 1 Stress to pull your element from miles away, so the other abilities work anywhere.

Kinesis (pyro or hydro; a stored-power version of Elementalist)

- *Start:* Push, pull, or lift things your size or smaller. Edge on rolls it helps.
- *Desperate:* after a roll, take 2 Stress to add +2.
- *Great feat:* at 6 Drive, spend all of it: one roll your power fuels is an automatic Impact 3.

Armored

- *Start:* Toughness 1 against everything.
- *Upgrade:* Toughness 2 against guns and blades.
- *Let it take the hit:* once per fight, ignore one hit entirely. Roll a d10: on 1 to 3, the armor breaks until you Patch Up at Dawn.

Animalism (pick a species or type)

- *Start:* You can talk to them, and Presence works on them like people.
- *Call:* Full Action, take 1 Stress: a group of 3 animals arrives and acts as an allied mook group for the scene. Allied mooks act on your turn and use one of your Quick Actions.

- *Swarm:* as Call, but a group of 6.

Shapeshifter (pick an animal)

- *Start:* Full Action, take 1 Stress: become the animal for a scene. +1 to one stat the form helps, -1 Focus. On a miss while shifted, the animal takes over until the scene ends. Shapeshifter always takes Allergy (silver, wolfsbane, a sound), since losing control is already built in.
- *Settled:* you can stay shifted as long as you like, and only lose control on a miss with doubles.
- *Hybrid:* take 2 Stress: for one fight, Advantage on Force and intimidation. Any miss and you attack the nearest person.

Vampirism (you must feed on people: blood, psychic energy, or emotions). You hold **Energy**, 0 to 5.

- *Start:* Feed. Roll Presence against a victim's Poise to gain Energy: +3 on Impact 2+, +2 on Impact 1, +2 and 1 Stress on a miss. Heat from feeding: none on Impact 2+ unless someone saw you; +1 Heat on Impact 1 (a witness, or a body that gets found); +1 Heat on a miss. Spend Energy for +1 per point on a roll, up to +2 per roll. At 0 Energy, take 1 Harm each Dawn until you feed.
- *Control:* spend 1 Energy for Advantage on a Presence roll.
- *Shapeshift:* spend 2 Energy to become a wolf or bat for a scene, Edge on rolls the form helps.

Elasticity

- *Start:* Squeeze. You fit through any gap. Edge on escapes and getting past barriers.
- *Stretch:* your Strikes reach Near range, and can hit two enemies in one zone with one roll.
- *Bounce:* Toughness 1 against blunt hits and falls. Follows the always-on rule: take 1 Stress the first time it stops a hit in a fight.

Shadow Manipulation

- *Start:* You can Vanish in any zone with shadows. While Hidden in a Dark zone, your attacks get Edge on top of Advantage.
- *Spread the dark:* Quick Action: roll Focus against 13. On a hit your zone becomes Dark, and adjacent zones too on Impact 2+.
- *Reveal:* once per fight, when you drop out of Hidden for dramatic effect, gain 2 Drive.

Illusions

- *Start:* Create an illusion that fools one sense. Edge on deception rolls and Vanish.
- *Full illusion:* take 1 Stress: an illusion that fools every sense. Once per scene, your next deception or escape roll is an automatic Impact 2.
- *Perfect illusion:* take 2 Stress: everyone who sees it believes it. Once per scene, your next deception or escape roll is an automatic Impact 3 (never an attack).

Force Fields

- *Start:* Quick Action: roll Focus against 13. On a hit, Toughness 2 until your next turn (Toughness 1 on Impact 1).
- *Shared:* you can cover an ally in your zone instead.
- *Containment:* Full Action: roll Focus against a target's Guard. On a hit, they're trapped while you keep focusing (you can't attack). Each of their turns, they can roll Force against your Wits to break free.

Temporal Instability (formerly Time Travel; always takes Unstable: misfires slip you or an ally out of sync with time)

- *Start:* Look. Take 1 Stress to see a place's past. On a lead roll hit there, take an extra clue.

- *Redo:* take 2 Stress after a miss to redo the roll with Edge.
- *Loop:* take 3 Stress to reroll Crack the Case.

Ice Control

- *Start:* Edge when you use ice to block, climb, or slide. You can make your zone a Hazard (ice) as a Quick Action.
- *Chill:* ice attacks at Near range, with Edge.
- *Freeze:* take 3 Stress: every mook in your zone loses their next turn. Named villains there resist: roll Focus against each one's Guard, and only those you beat lose their turn.

Weather Control

- *Start:* Change the weather over a neighborhood in about ten minutes. Rain, fog, or storm can make zones Dark or Hazard.
- *Drastic:* change it in a round, even impossibly (snow in July, rain indoors). Each use ticks Heat by 1: a freak storm is obviously somebody's doing.
- *Weather as a weapon:* attacks with lightning, hail, or wind at Near or Far range, with Edge.

Conspicuous: there's no subtle way to use Weather Control. Your eyes glow, the wind circles you, the clouds center on you. Using any of its abilities ends Hidden, you can't Vanish that round, and anyone watching knows it's you.

Invulnerability (write in a weakness)

- *Start:* when you would take Harm from a physical attack, take that much Stress instead. Work out the Harm first (weapon bonuses, then Toughness, then the 1-Harm minimum), then convert what's left. Your weakness gets through normally, and once your Stress is full (8), anything more spills into Harm. Since every hit already costs Stress, Invulnerability skips the always-on first-hit Stress cost.
- *Untouchable:* after people see you shrug off a hit, Edge on Presence rolls to intimidate them.
- *Can't die:* if you would die, even to your weakness, you fall into a coma for 2d10 days instead.

Cloning

- *Start:* One clone. When it Helps you, you get Advantage instead of Edge. Once per fight it can take a hit for you, then it's gone until Dawn.
- *Many:* your clones act as an allied mook group of 3. Like all allied mooks, they act on your turn and use one of your Quick Actions.
- *The Prestige:* one perfect clone. If you ever die, keep playing as the clone, but it comes back a little wrong: start at 4 Stress (Fraying) and tick Home by 2.

Plant Control

- *Start:* Edge on rolls where plants help (needs plants in the zone).
- *Entangle:* when your attack hits, the target can't move on their next turn instead of taking Harm.
- *Green healing:* a breather among plants clears Bruised and Hurt.

Sand Manipulation

- *Start:* Turn part or all of yourself to sand. Edge on escapes, squeezing, and slipping grabs.
- *Sand fists:* your bare hands count as heavy melee (+1 Harm on any hit) and work with Strikes, not Jabs.
- *Reform:* Patch Up anywhere with sand clears Down too. If you would die, you scatter and reform in 2d10 days. Water is the natural Allergy for this power.

Mighty (beyond peak human; the strange version of Peak Strength)

- *Start:* lift and throw cars. Force attacks get +1 Harm on Impact 2+ and ignore Toughness, and you can throw heavy objects at Near range.
- *Wrecking:* Full Action: smash a wall, floor or vehicle to remove Cover from a zone, open a path between zones, or make a zone Hazard.
- *Big leap:* your free move can cross two zones or reach High Ground.

Sorcery (spells, rituals, old books)

- *Start:* at the start of each Night, prepare 3 spells. Casting one is a Quick Action, once per spell per fight (roll Focus where a roll is needed). Bolt: a Near attack that ignores Toughness. Ward: +2 Guard to an ally until your next turn. Bind: on a hit, the target can't move on their next turn. Sight: see the hidden, invisible or supernatural in your zone.
- *Deeper study:* prepare 4 spells.
- *Ritual:* out of a fight, take 3 Stress and spend a scene: scry for a clue about a person or place, or call up help for one fight.

Luck (probability bends around you)

- *Start:* once per fight, reroll any roll you make and keep the new result.
- *Share it:* you can give that reroll to an ally instead.
- *Lucky break:* once per Night, turn one of your Misses into Impact 1.

If Luck takes Unstable, its misfire is bad luck spilling over: on your Miss, an ally nearby takes the GM's move instead of you.

Healing Factor (wounds close as you watch; the strange version of Resilient)

- *Start:* at the end of each of your turns in a fight, clear one Harm box (not Down). If anyone hurt you since your last turn, that heal costs 1 Stress. The first time it heals you in a fight, take the usual 1 Stress too.
- *Get back up:* when you go Down, you're back up at Wounded at the end of your next turn, no Drive needed.
- *Hard to kill:* when you would die, you don't. You're out until the next scene, then up at Wounded. Your Allergy (adamantium, fire, a beheading blade) can still kill you.

Iron Skin

- *Start:* Quick Action to turn your skin to metal, paying the usual 1 Stress for a strange power. It lasts until the end of the fight or scene. While armored: Toughness 1 against everything, including guns, but you're heavy and slow, with Disadvantage on Vanish and climbing, and you can't use Flow to dodge falls or swim. Your metal fists count as heavy melee (+1 Harm on any hit, Full Action Strikes).
- *Steel:* once per fight while armored, take 1 Stress to reduce one hit by 1 more Impact, to a minimum of 0.
- *Unbreakable:* once per Night, when a hit would put you Down, take 2 Stress instead of the Harm.

Fear Aura

- *Start:* Edge on Presence rolls to intimidate.
- *Dread:* take 1 Stress: a Presence attack against every mook group in your zone. Any group you beat runs. Fearless mooks (fanatics, cultists, the mind-controlled) ignore Dread.
- *Nightmare:* take 2 Stress: a Presence attack against one named enemy's Poise. On a hit, they take Stress equal to the Impact and can't attack you on their next turn.

Shock Touch

- *Start:* when your Jab hits, the target loses their next Quick Action.
- *Blackout:* a Strike that also kills the lights. Your zone becomes Dark.
- *Overload:* take 1 Stress: on a hit with your Strike, the target loses their whole next turn and one gun or gadget they carry is fried. (Like all electricity, Shock Touch already ignores Toughness.)

Levitation (a light, slow cousin of Flight)

- *Start:* Float up or down slowly. Your free move can reach High Ground or drop from any height, and falls never hurt you. Staying airborne costs: the first round is free, then 1 Stress for each round you stay up. Outside a fight, a short hover is free, but holding it for a whole scene costs 1 Stress. This per-round cost replaces the usual strange-power first-use Stress.
- *Drift:* while airborne, enemies on the ground can only reach you with ranged attacks, and you can move one extra zone through open air.
- *Lift:* carry one person with you when you float. Their weight doubles the Stress cost.

Villain-only powers

Too big for street-level heroes, but fine for a Nemesis: **Biokinesis** (reshape your body, slip away as a puddle), **Invisibility** (always Hidden unless you attack), **Flight** (move to any zone, ignore High Ground), **Telekinesis** (throw things at any range, lift a truck for 2 Stress), and **Clairvoyance** (prophetic dreams; the GM can call one villain move "foreseen" and it can't be stopped by Called It). The original, unweakened Supersworn versions of Toughness, Enhanced Senses, Super-Strength, and Healing Factor also suit villains.

Sample loadouts

Hero	Slots	Loadout
Bulwark	Street power (1) + 2 gear	Just the knife; Resilience (source: years of hauling hoses), med kit, riot shield
Rook	Free weapon + 3 gear	Free weighted gloves; Kevlar vest, med kit, police scanner
Nightjar	Free weapon + strange power (2) + gear (1)	Free fighting sticks; Shadow Manipulation (Allergy: floodlights burn her skin), grapple line
Patchwork	3 gear	Just the knife; night-vision goggles, grapple line, earpiece comms (plus a utility belt)
The Ledger	Free weapon + 3 gear	Free concealed sidearm; Kevlar vest, police scanner, burner phones

Villains

A villain fits in a short stat block. They use the same stats, defenses, and Drive prices as heroes, but skip the parts that only matter for player characters.

What a villain has

- **Stats and defenses**, same as a hero.
- **Harm:** 5 for a lieutenant, 10 for a case's main villain (8 for a smaller one).
- **Stress: 4 boxes.** Fraying at 2, Breaking at 4. Presence attacks and Stress Flairs fill it. A Breaking villain does something reckless: flees, turns on their own people, or gives something away.
- **Trait:** one line for Fraying and one for Breaking.
- **Drive:** starts at 2, earned from their role trigger once per round. Same spend prices as heroes.
- **Trick:** one special move that costs Drive.

- **Weakness:** something the heroes can discover (a Detective's Read, an Impact 3 on Patrol) and exploit.

Answer Toughness: every named villain should have at least one way past Toughness: fire, electricity, gas, a hazard they can trigger, or a Presence attack. Otherwise an armored hero can't be hurt.

Scaling to the party:

- **Villain turns:** a named villain gets one turn per round for every two heroes, rounded up. One turn against 1 or 2 heroes, two against 3 or 4. Spread the turns through the round. A villain fighting alone, with no mooks or lieutenants, gets one turn per hero instead.
- **Lieutenants and several named enemies:** a lieutenant gets one turn per round, however many heroes there are, even fighting alone. When a fight has more than one named enemy, each villain takes its own turns by the rule above and each lieutenant takes one; no villain counts as alone while another named enemy is in the fight. Spread all their turns through the round.
- **Gang size:** in a fight with no named villain, start with one group of 3 mooks per hero. With a named villain present, one group per two heroes (rounded down, minimum 1). Then adjust for how hard the fight should be.

Roles

Role	Earns Drive when	Typical Trick
Heavy	They deal or take Impact 2+	Ignore one hit (2 Drive)
Mastermind	One of their clocks ticks	A mook group acts out of turn (1), tick a villain clock (2)
Nemesis	They target their rival	Cancel the rival's Drive spend (2)
Trickster	A hero misses them	Swap places with a mook in sight (2), force a reroll (1)
Mooks	Never	None. They act in groups of 3.

Sample villains

```
THE BUTCHER OF FIFTH STREET (Heavy, case boss)
Force +4  Flow 0  Focus +1  Presence +2
Guard 12  Wits 13  Poise 14   Harm 10  Toughness 1  Stress 4
Trait: Spite. Fraying: goes after whoever hurt him last, plan or no plan.
       Breaking: wrecks everything in reach, his own men included.
Drive: deals or takes Impact 2+
Trick (2 Drive): Human shield. Redirect a hit to a hostage in his zone.
Weakness: can't turn down a challenge in front of his crew.

AUGUSTINE VOSS, THE LANDLORD (Mastermind, case boss)
Force -1  Flow +1  Focus +4  Presence +3
Guard 13  Wits 16  Poise 15   Harm 5  Stress 4
Trait: Order. Fraying: sticks to the plan even as it falls apart.
       Breaking: runs, and sets the building on fire behind him.
Drive: one of his clocks ticks (Eviction, Evidence)
Trick (1 Drive): a mook group acts out of turn.
      (2 Drive): tick the Eviction clock.
Weakness: his handwritten ledger. Without it, his network falls apart.

FIFTH STREET SAINTS (Mooks, groups of 3)
Attack +2   Guard 13  Wits 12  Poise 12   Harm 1 each
One attack per group per turn, with Edge if all 3 are standing.
One in each group carries a pistol (+1 Harm on Impact 2+, ignores natural Toughness but not armor, +1 Heat).
They run when half the gang is down, unless a boss is in sight.
```

Old Habits: changing your Trait

People change, but not cleanly. At the end of an **arc** (several cases tied together), a hero can trade their Trait for a new one, if the player and GM agree the story earned it.

The first change

Take the new Trait. The old one becomes an **Old Habit**: you can still use its Steady perk, but it costs 1 Drive each time. Its hook and Breaking fallout are gone.

Then pick **2** of these:

- Clear all Stress and reset your Home clock to 0.
- Gain a Flair that fits the new Trait.
- Your maximum Drive goes up to 7.

The second change

This should be rare, maybe once in a long campaign. Take the new Trait and lose your Old Habit entirely. The table picks **2** kinds of fallout:

- **Allies shift:** a contact, team member, or faction sees you differently.
- **Public opinion:** start a new clock for how much the city trusts (or fears) you.
- **The nemesis adapts:** a recurring villain gains a new Trick built to counter the new you.
- **The city remembers:** add a lasting change to the setting that reflects who you became.
- **The price of becoming someone new:** give up a resource, a relationship, or your home turf.

Arcs

An arc is 3 to 5 cases tied together by someone working behind the scenes, the **Mastermind**. Each case stands on its own, but each one leaves fingerprints that point at the same person.

To design later: the threat behind an arc won't always be a person. It could be a volcano, or an astral alignment that opens a rift on its own unless someone counters it. Those arcs need their own version of Tools, calling cards and Unmasking.

The arc sheet (GM)

- **Mastermind:** who's really behind it. This can start blank (see Promotion).
- **Endgame:** what happens to the city if they win.
- **Tools:** the villains of each case. Each one works for the Mastermind, knowingly or not, and each knows one thing about them.
- **Calling card:** one detail that turns up in every case: a shell company's name, a chalk mark, a matchbook. Players should spot it by the second case.
- **Endgame clock:** 8 segments.
- **Arc clues:** a running list, separate from case clues.

The Endgame clock

It ticks when	Ticks
A case's Scheme clock fills	+2
A Tool escapes, or a theory names the wrong culprit	+1

It ticks when	Ticks
The heroes miss an Unmasking roll	+1

- **At 4:** the Mastermind makes it personal. Pick one hero and hit their Home: a loved one is threatened, a landlord calls, someone starts asking about their nights.
- **At 8:** the Endgame happens. The finale becomes damage control instead of prevention.

Getting arc clues

- Impact 3 on Crack the Case (already in the rules).
- Impact 3 on a lead: take an arc clue as your bonus instead.
- Finding the calling card in a case, the first time each case.
- Taking a Tool alive and breaking them in an interrogation scene (Presence against their Poise).

Promotion: when the GM hasn't decided yet

An arc can start **Floating**, the same way a case can. The arc sheet just says *someone*. As cases play out, watch for the villain who got away, the one the players hate most, the name that keeps coming up. When the GM is ready (usually around the third case, or when the Endgame clock hits 4), promote that character to Mastermind and fill in the sheet. Reread the old arc clues in that light. Any that don't fit were someone else's mess. The players never need to know when it happened.

Unmasking

With at least 3 arc clues, the team can theorize the arc: who the Mastermind is and what their Endgame is. Roll **2d10 + arc clues against 16** (Complexity 6). With 4 arc clues that's right 55% of the time, and 6 arc clues gets you to 64%.

Result	Meaning
Miss	Wrong, and the Mastermind knows you're onto them. Endgame clock +1.
Impact 1	Right, but they're a step ahead. The finale happens on their terms.
Impact 2	Right. You choose when and where the finale happens.
Impact 3	Right, plus their Weakness, and one of their Tools turns on them

If the roll hits but names the wrong person, you've found the Mastermind's right hand, as with cases.

The finale

The finale is a Complexity 8 case against the Mastermind. Afterwards, each hero can change their Trait (Old Habits). A beaten Mastermind can come back in a later arc as a Tool, or as someone's Nemesis.

Example arc: The Landlord

- **Mastermind:** Augustine Voss, a landlord quietly buying up the east side.
- **Endgame:** empty the neighborhood, burn what's left, and rebuild it as his.
- **Tools:** the Butcher (a protection racket that scares tenants out), an arson crew, a crooked fire inspector, a city councilman.
- **Calling card:** every building that gets hit has an eviction notice from the same shell company, Harbor & Main Holdings.

Test fight: The Cannery

One short fight to check the math: **Rook** (Brawler) and **Nightjar** (Stalker) against **the Butcher** and 6 Fifth Street Saints, with a hostage on the line. It should take 4 to 6 rounds.

[embedded content: The Cannery · 4 zones]

Setup

- The heroes cracked the case with an Impact 2, so they chose the ground: Nightjar starts Hidden on the Catwalk.
- Both heroes start with 1 Drive, no Harm, and no Stress.
- **Hazard (Kill Floor):** anyone who misses a roll in this zone takes 1 Harm from the hooks. A Haymaker can knock someone into them.
- **Hostage clock: 4.** It ticks at the end of every round, after everyone's turns (clocks in a fight always tick last). When it fills, the Butcher's men hurt the hostage, and every hero takes 2 Stress.

Winning

The heroes win if they drop the Butcher, **or** a hero reaches the Freezer and spends an Interact to free the hostage while no enemy is in that zone. The Saints run when 3 of them are down, unless the Butcher can see them.

What to watch for

- How many rounds did it take? The target is 4 to 6.
- Did anyone go Down? Did Rook's Toughness make a difference?
- How much Drive did each hero earn and spend? Did anyone get to a Signature Move?
- Did anyone reach Fraying? Did the GM use a hook?
- Was Jab ever worth it over a Strike?
- Did the hostage clock change what the heroes did, or did they ignore it?
- Did the zones and Hidden feel tactical without counting squares?

After one or two runs, adjust the numbers that felt off: Harm boxes, villain Harm, Drive earn rate, or the Impact bands.

Playtest notes

Where the rules stand (Nov 10). The chapters above are the current rules. These started as trial rules and are now settled after the voice session, the simulator and four Gemini sessions: Second Wind, guns at Disadvantage in melee, Dark zones, reduced mook spill, the 2-Harm mook cap, villain turns and gang size scaling with the party, the four Stress rules, strange powers costing Stress, power flaws, and the slot system.

Resolved Nov 10

- **Protector and Detective Drive.** The Protector now earns from any attack against them, hit or miss. The Detective also earns when an ally hits using the Edge from their Read. Luke went from 0.29 to 0.62 Drive a round; win rates didn't move.
- **Guard 15 enemies.** Kept, with GM advice under Fights (Hard-to-hit enemies): one per fight at most, and make sure the fight offers a way to get Edge or Advantage: Read, Help, Hidden, a Flashbang, High Ground.
- **The Specialist against guns.** Kit is now in the simulator. Smoke cuts Patchwork's chance of going Down against gunmen from 28% to 23%, and the Kit text now says to take Smoke or Armor when guns are expected. Prepared's trap now ignores Toughness, which lifts parties with a Specialist about 4 points.

- **Already Broken** starts each Night with 4 Drive. In the simulator Rook gets 1.7 Signatures a fight instead of 1.1, and Nightjar (who already runs hot) Breaks in 70% of fights instead of 18%. A real trade, which is the point.
- **Lethality.** Kept as it is. Death only comes when an enemy hits a hero who is already Down, and the Harm rules now tell the GM to treat that as a deliberate, announced move.
- **Fight length.** A case's main villain has 10 Harm (8 for a smaller one). The Cannery now runs 4.7 rounds with a 90.6% win rate.
- **Toughness villains.** If a Detective's Read asks about the weakness, the hit using that Edge ignores Toughness. With guns, Mighty, the Taser and the trap, every party now has an answer to armor.
- **The Order Trait.** Session 1 showed Order giving Edge on almost every roll. Its Steady perk is now: name one step of your plan, and the roll for that step has Edge, whoever makes it. Once per scene.

Still to watch

- **Parties with no fighter** (Patchwork, the Ledger, Jessica) win only 38% of the Cannery. That's intended: they should win the case and pick their ground first. Check it at a table.
- **A villain fighting alone** goes down in 3.4 rounds. If that feels short in play, give solo villains 12 Harm.
- **The new Order perk and Already Broken** haven't been played yet.

Not yet tested at a table

- Every trial Flair (Resources, Acrobat, Already Broken, The Roast, Trick Arrows, Patient Hunter, Sucker Punch, Bodyguard, Quick Study, Chill, Rooftop Runner, Smarmy and Scrapper), the "More tools" list and Assets.
- The Loyalty, Obsession, Fear and Duty Traits, which are new and have not been played or simulated.
- The Bow as a free weapon, and the Weighted lash and Scoped rifle, which the simulator models only as a light weapon and a pistol.
- Most powers. Only Shadow Manipulation, Resilience, Invulnerability, Mighty and Healing Factor have seen play or the simulator.
- Floating mysteries (one rough Gemini run), Arcs, Old Habits, and Dawn choices across several Nights.

GM practice (from the voice session)

- When a clock or threat is about to resolve, say "this round" or "next turn" precisely.
- Show Harm as boxes filled ("5 of 8 taken"), on sheets and in narration.
- A complication has to fit the fiction. A chain put on tonight isn't rusted.
- Give most fights a goal besides a knockout.

Change log

- **After Session 1 (voice):** the gun bonus only applies on Impact 2 or better. Mook attacks cap at 2 Harm, applied last. Heroes got gear and powers. Hazards hurt enemies too. Advantage and Edge stack.
- **Difficulty pass (simulator):** an Impact 3 drops two mooks instead of one per Impact. Villain turns and gang size scale with the party.
- **Powers pass:** the slot system replaced the Gifted and Equipped packages. Strange powers cost Stress and need a flaw. Armored and Invulnerability became always-on strange powers. Street powers were rebalanced, and Flairs, gear and Assets were added.
- **Balance pass (Nov 9, simulator):** defenses went from 10 + stat to 12 + stat, case villains to 8 Harm, lieutenants to 5, and a lone villain gets one turn per hero. Before: heroes hit 80 to 90%, won 93 to 100%, and fights lasted 2 to 3 rounds. After: about 63% hits and 4 to 4.5 rounds.
- **Rulings from the Gemini sessions (Nov 9 and 10):** Impact tops out at 3, and bonuses add Harm, not Impact. A Jab never gets Impact 2 bonuses. An always-on power doesn't work against its Allergy.

Toughness applies before Invulnerability. Clocks tick last in a round. Scheme Stress only hits the hero whose roll caused the tick. Unstable misfires mostly hit the scene. A Down hero gets up at Wounded after the fight. Seeing an ally go Down costs Stress once per fight. A single hit stops at Down. Breaking while Down waits. Healing Factor heals under fire for 1 Stress.

- **Drive and Mighty (Nov 10, simulator):** heroes start each Night with 2 Drive, because they earn 0.3 to 0.8 a round, not 1. Average win went from 90% to 93% and the weakest party from 17% to 37%, with about one Signature per fight. Mighty ignores Toughness, which lifted the weakest party from 17% to 32%. Together: 93% average, weakest party 45%.
- **Tested and rejected:** wider Impact bands (no effect), Mighty with +1 Harm on any hit (armor ate it), starting with 3 Drive (too comfortable), Healing Factor that only works when nobody hurt you (it never worked), and Stress on a miss (never adopted).
- **Method:** Gemini invents dice and simulator tables unless it is handed a numbered dice bank, and every log needs an audit. Use the simulator for numbers and a live session for feel.
- **Open-questions pass (Nov 10, simulator):** Specialist Kit (Taser, Flashbang, Smoke) and Prepared are now simulated. Changes: Protector and Detective Drive triggers widened, Prepared's trap and a Read weakness ignore Toughness, case villains 10 Harm, Already Broken starts at 4 Drive, the Order perk reworked, and GM advice for hard-to-hit enemies and killing blows. Result across all 56 three-hero parties: the Cannery 90.6% wins in 4.7 rounds (weakest party 38%), the gun lieutenant 92.5% in 3.9 rounds, and every hero averages about one Signature a fight. Kit with Edge was tested and rejected (too small to be worth a rule).
- **Several named enemies (Nov 11, Stephen):** a fight can have more than one villain or lieutenant. Villains keep the usual turns; a lieutenant always gets one turn per round. The simulator and the Encounter lab model this; a single villain's fight is unchanged.

Playtest log: Session 1

Every roll from the first playtest, in order. Stephen played The Ledger (Ruth); the GM ran Rook and Nightjar. Dice came from the true-random dice bank. Defense = the number to beat; margin = total minus defense.

Night 1: the Calloway annex fire

#	Who: action	Roll	Dice	Total vs def	Result
1	Rook: Strike a Saint	Force +4	5, 3	12 vs 11	Impact 1. Saint down (taken alive). Brawler +1 Drive (2)
2	Rook: Pile Through Jab	Force +4, -2	1, 4	7 vs 11	Miss. GM move: pistol Saint backs off, draws
3	Saints: pistol at Rook	+2	9, 7	18 vs 12	Impact 2, +1 gun = 3 Harm (Battered). Heat 1. Rook's Spite Edge on
4	Ruth: free the hose coupling	Focus +4, Order Edge	7, 9	22 vs 11	Impact 3. Bonus: Nightjar gets Edge on her climb
5	Nightjar: climb the wall	Flow +4, Edge	6, 3	15 vs 13	Impact 1. Cost: 1 Harm from the hot sill (Bruised). Ties hose to radiator
	End of round 1				Annex collapse clock 1 of 4
6	Ruth: talk family down the hose	Presence +2, Order Edge	10, 4	18 vs 13	Impact 2. Both kids down. Ruth moves them clear (no roll)
7	Saints: pistol at Rook	+2	1, 9	12 vs 12	Impact 1, +1 gun = 2 Harm. Rook Down. Brawler +1 Drive (3). Van starts
8	Nightjar: drop from roof to alley	Flow +4	2, 6	12 vs 13	Miss. 1 Harm (Hurt), loses surprise. Vengeance +1 Drive (2)

#	Who: action	Roll	Dice	Total vs def	Result
9	Nightjar: Strike pistol Saint	Flow +4, Edge (1 Drive)	2, 1	9 vs 11	Miss. GM move: van rolls out
10	Rook (Down): stab the van tire	Force +4, Disadvantage	3, 3, 6 (kept 3, 3)	10 vs 11	Miss. Van escapes. Personal clue: Nightjar's plate (counts 2)
	End of round 2				Annex collapse clock 2 of 4
11	Ruth: talk the mother down	Presence +2, Order Edge	10, 7	21 vs 13	Impact 3. Rescue complete. Bonus clue: suited property woman's buyout offer. Detective +1 Drive (3)
12	Rook: Second Wind	3 Drive	none	none	Down to Wounded, Rook at 0 Drive
13	Nightjar: lead the getaway	Flow +4	1, 4	9 vs 11	Miss. Filmed on a phone: Heat 2
14	Ruth: interrogate the Saint	Presence +2, Order Edge	1, 10	15 vs 13	Impact 1. Clue: burner rings a downtown property office. Detective +1 Drive (4). Player chose Heat (3)

Dawn. Rook: Patch Up, Show Up. Nightjar: Patch Up, Work the Case (Home 1). Ruth: Work the Case, Lay Low (Heat 2, Home 1, Drive capped to 3). Work the Case clues: silver Lexus meets the van at the docks; Friday city inspection condemns Calloway under 10 occupied units. Scheme 1 of 6. Arc clue: Harbor & Main Holdings eviction notice (calling card). Case clues: 6.

Night 2: leads, the Cannery, the pier

#	Who: action	Roll	Dice	Total vs def	Result
	Ruth plans: each hero works their best lead				Order +1 Drive (4)
15	Rook: lean on Kenny Lam (pawnshop)	Force +4	6, 7	17 vs 13	Impact 2. Clue: ledger, six gas cans sold to Saints
16	Nightjar: break into the property office	Flow +4	6, 8	18 vs 15	Impact 1. Clue: "Vacate by Friday. D.M." + D. Marsh's Lexus. Cost (GM offered 2): Scheme 2
17	Ruth: search the cooled annex	Focus +4, Order Edge	6, 4	16 vs 11	Impact 2. Clue: Tidewater Seafood rag. Detective +1 Drive (5)
	Scheme tick 2				Rosa calls: Marco is missing
18	Team: Crack the Case	9 clues + Case Sense = +10	4, 2	16 vs 16	Impact 1; Ruth spends 2 Drive to raise it to Impact 2 (Drive 3). Theory: D. Marsh, clearing Calloway for redevelopment, Tidewater cannery. Heroes choose the ground: Kill Floor made Dark
	Ruth plans: Rook and Nightjar distract, Ruth frees Marco				Order +1 Drive (4)
19	Rook: Strike a dock Saint	Force +4	4, 4	12 vs 11	Impact 1. Saint down. Brawler +1 Drive (2)
20	Rook: Pile Through Jab	Force +4, -2	2, 4	8 vs 11	Miss. GM move: dock Saints take Cover (+2 Guard)
21	Dock Saints: pistol at Rook	+2	1, 5	8 vs 12	Miss

#	Who: action	Roll	Dice	Total vs def	Result
22	Nightjar: Strike from Hidden (Kill Floor, Dark)	Flow +4, Advantage	8, 7, 5 (kept 8, 7)	19 vs 11	Impact 3. Spill drops all 3 Kill Floor Saints. Stalker +1 Drive (2). Hidden ends
23	Butcher: backhand Nightjar	Force +4, Edge (1 Drive)	9, 1	16 vs 14	Impact 1. Nightjar Bruised. Her Vengeance Edge on
24	Ruth: open the padlocked freezer	Focus +4, Order Edge	6, 2	14 vs 13	Impact 1. Player chose 1 Harm (Bruised) over losing time. Marco freed: fight won in 1 round. Saints flee (morale), Butcher runs
25	Nightjar: chase the Butcher	Flow +4, Vengeance Edge	5, 7	18 vs 10	Impact 3. Cornered at the end of a rotting pier. Vengeance +1 Drive (3)
26	Rook: Strike the Butcher	Force +4	10, 3	17 vs 10	Impact 2, Toughness -1 = 1 Harm (1 of 7). Declined 2-Drive upgrade
27	Butcher: swing at Rook	Force +4	3, 1	8 vs 12	Miss. Pier hazard: 1 Harm (2 of 7)
28	Nightjar: Strike, he's down	Flow +4, Edge, Advantage	4, 1, 6 (kept 6, 4)	16 vs 10	Impact 2, Toughness -1 = 1 Harm (3 of 7). Declined upgrade
29	Nightjar: Strike again	Flow +4, Edge, Advantage	4, 10, 4 (kept 10, 4)	20 vs 10	Impact 3, Toughness -1 = 2 Harm (5 of 7)
30	Butcher: lunge at Nightjar	Force +4, Edge (last Drive)	2, 3	11 vs 14	Miss. Pier hazard: 1 Harm (6 of 7). Opportunist +1 Drive (4)
31	Rook: grab and slam him down	Force +4	10, 2	16 vs 10	Impact 2, Toughness -1 = 1 Harm (7 of 7). Butcher taken alive. Brawler +1 Drive (3)

Ending state. Ruth: Bruised, 4 Drive, 0 Stress. Rook: Wounded at Night 1 end, healed at Dawn, 3 Drive. Nightjar: Bruised, 4 Drive. Heat 2, Scheme 2, both Home clocks 1. Case cracked; arc clue 1. Butcher captured but not yet interrogated (arc clue available: Presence vs Poise 12).

GM errors to check:

- **Dice bank order slipped twice.** Roll 18 read the dice as 4, 2 (bank had 2, 4; same total), and roll 19 then reused one die. Roll 31 skipped a die: the bank's next dice were 8, 10 (22 vs 10, Impact 3), which still drops the Butcher. The stored bank's "next" marker hasn't been updated; about the first 63 dice are used.
- **Turn-timing wording:** the van "leaves this turn" (it left the same round).
- **Advantage on a downed foe** was a GM ruling, not a written rule.
- **Rook's Drive at Night 2 start** was treated as 1, the starting Drive at the time (it is now 2).